



LUCKNOW

1 Crore Competency

Uttar Pradesh Chief Minister Mayawati has few competitors in the pageantry of power. While celebrating the silver jubilee of the Bahujan Samaj Party, known for its support to the oppressed, Mayawati was welcomed with a garland made of currency notes in Rs-1,000 denomination. Infuriated by the indulgence, the Congress and Samajwadi Party have demanded a CBI inquiry into the source of the money, saying the ornament around her would have been worth over Rs 3 crore. Senior minister Nasimuddin Siddiqui, however, claimed the garland had currency notes valued at Rs 21 lakh which were contributed by workers of the Lucknow unit. It is said a sum of Rs 200 crore was spent on the show. The entire state capital was bathed in blue light; lodging and dining arrangements were made for 10 lakh people; 14 CCTVs were installed at the rally site; 1,000 quintals of flowers were brought from across the country to decorate the city; 1,600 state buses and 5,000 private buses were used to ferry the workers. Special trains were also booked and over 10 lakh LED lights were installed. Yet, the BSP could not achieve its target of bringing in over 20 lakh workers. Congress leader Akhilesh Pratap Singh said, "Mayawati spent Rs 300 crore, but could not manage to bring in even three lakh people. Still, she kept cursing the Opposition and UPA for the plight of the people of Uttar Pradesh." *by Farzand Ahmed*

**MAYAWATI BEING
GARLANDED BY
HER PARTYMEN**

3

crore rupees is what the Opposition estimates as cost of the garland Mayawati was given on the BSP's 25th anniversary.